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MODULE 1 · EXPERIMENT WITH AI AGENTS · LESSON 1

Exercise 2: Ambiguous Prompting

WHY THIS EXERCISE

Getting useful results from an AI agent often takes more than one try. Throughout this course—and especially in your Capstone Project—you'll need to test agent outputs and refine your instructions to improve quality. This exercise gives you your first practice with that cycle: start vague, observe what happens, and keep refining until the output is actually useful.

INSTRUCTIONS

In this exercise, you'll see what happens when you give an AI agent a vague prompt—and then practice turning it into a useful one.

> *"I need help preparing for an important meeting next week. Create whatever materials you think I need."*

This prompt is deliberately vague. When you paste it into an agent, look at what comes back and ask yourself: *What's wrong or missing from this output? What would I actually need instead?* That gap between what the agent produced and what you needed tells you what was missing from the prompt.

The lesson showed how a well-structured prompt includes a clear task, specific steps, constraints, and a desired output format. Use that as a guide: when the output falls short, figure out which of those pieces the agent didn't have, and add them. If you feel stuck, try asking yourself questions like: *Who is the meeting with? What do I need to walk away with? Would an agenda, a set of talking points, or a one-page summary be most useful?*

SETUP

You should still have the four agents open from Exercise 1. If not, reopen at least two or three of them:

- **Claude** — claude.ai
- **ChatGPT** — chatgpt.com
- **Gemini** — gemini.google.com
- **Copilot** — copilot.microsoft.com

TASKS

1. Paste the prompt above into two or three of the agents. Take a quick look at how each one handles the vague request.
2. Pick one agent. Look at what it produced, identify what's missing or not useful, and rewrite the prompt to close the gap. Repeat until the output is genuinely useful. If possible, use a real upcoming meeting from your work, your job search, or your personal life.
3. Answer the questions below.

QUESTION 1

Before you started refining, how did the agents handle the vague prompt? For example, did any of them ask clarifying questions, or did they just assume what you needed and run with it?

Gemini Assumed based on the previous documents in the conversation. Copilot gave general tips on how to create a universal, high-impact preparation kit for most professional settings. chatGpt asked for more context. Claude asked for specific inputs from me then produced a 30-minute agenda structured.

QUESTION 2

After refining, what prompt produced the best result?

Instead of rewriting the prompt myself, I answered the clarifying questions Claude asked me — such as the meeting duration, purpose, and format needed. Once Claude had those specific inputs from me, it produced a 30-minute agenda that was structure

QUESTION 3

What was wrong or missing from the original output, and what did you change in your prompt to fix it?

the original prompt was missing thee four key things clear task, specific steps, constraints and the output format. Answered Claude's questions to change to fix it.

QUESTION 4

What did this exercise reveal about creating effective prompts for agents?

The more specific with the prompt including the task, steps, constraints, and output format the better the result. Instead of letting the agent assume, answering its clarifying questions or adding details upfront saves time and gives exactly what we need

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